

As Musk slashes government, the heartland may take outsized hit

Kansas City has become a major hub for federal workers, in part due to GOP efforts to move jobs there

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When President Trump and his supporters talk about draining the “swamp” of the federal government bureaucracy, they probably don’t have Kansas City in mind.

But with Trump’s top ally Elon Musk and his team moving rapidly to gut the government in Washington, that middle America metropolitan area of 2.2 million people is becoming emblematic of how some communities thousands of miles from the Beltway will feel disproportionate economic pain from the Department of Government Efficiency.

The region, which spans both Missouri and Kansas, might be famous for football and barbeque, but over the years, it has quietly grown into a hub for federal government workers.

There are about 30,000 federal employees in the Kansas City area — putting it tied for the fourth-highest proportion of federal workers of any metro area outside Washington, D.C., Maryland, and Virginia, according to the Mid-America Regional Council, a consortium of local governments that serves as the metropolitan planning organization for the region.

Politicians, particularly Republicans, have favored the idea of moving federal jobs to places like Kansas City, which is how the Internal Revenue Service ended up operating a major tax filing processing hub in that city’s downtown. And in his first term, Trump controversially moved a US Department of Agriculture office to Kansas City from D.C., adding to the agency’s presence there. The Environmental Protection Agency and the Social Security Administration also have regional hubs in Kansas City.

But just over a month into Trump’s second term, DOGE’s federal workforce cuts have come swiftly to the region.

On Wednesday, the local union representing IRS workers there told local media outlets that up to 1,000 people at the processing center were imminently being fired. That would represent one-third of

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New England a hotbed of anti-Trump litigation

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — It may be one of the smallest federal court circuits in the country, but in the early days of the Trump administration, New England is emerging as a top battleground to sue the Trump administration.

It’s a change from President Trump’s first term in office, when lawsuits against his policies were heavily clustered on the West Coast. But experts say it’s no coincidence, as the appellate region that makes up the First Circuit has become one of the most advantageous places for those challenging Trump policies to file their litigation, for a variety of reasons including its all-Democratic appointee make-up at the appellate level.

“If you’re a progressive ... it would be malpractice to not go to the First Circuit,” said John Yoo, a professor at the University of California Berkeley who

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SANCTUARY CITIES FILE SUIT

Chelsea and Somerville are challenging what they call unconstitutional Trump administration orders that could threaten millions in federal transportation and public safety funds. **B1.**



CONFUSION OVER EMAIL

President Trump praised Elon Musk’s email to federal workers, which demanded they respond or be fired, even as his personnel department said a response was voluntary. **A2.**

Quiet Maine town at center of transgender sports clash

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

CUMBERLAND, Maine — As it is on most days, Main Street in Cumberland was quiet on Monday morning — sleepy, even, as cars only occasionally whirled past the towering snow banks lining the way. You’d never guess this town is at the heart of a gathering storm.

That storm, of course, is President Trump’s recent executive order banning transgender athletes from participating in women’s and girl’s sports, and Maine Governor Janet Mills’ refusal to comply.

Even before Mills and Trump

faced off at a White House meeting on Friday, Cumberland was already in the spotlight after a Republican state legislator posted on social media about a transgender student athlete who had helped secure a state cross country title.

In one post, Representative Laurel Libby displayed photos of the student, before and after transitioning, standing on award podiums. In another, she called the Maine Principals’ Association decision to allow transgender students to compete “outrageous and unfair.”

In response, Maine House

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US, Europe in seismic split

In UN resolutions, Trump administration refuses to blame Russia for war with Ukraine

GLOBE NEWS SERVICES

UNITED NATIONS — In a dramatic shift in transatlantic relations under President Trump, the United States split with its European allies by refusing to blame Russia for its invasion of Ukraine in votes on UN resolutions Monday seeking an end to the three-year war.

The United States joined Russia in voting against a Europe-backed Ukrainian resolution that denounced Moscow’s aggression and demanded an immediate withdrawal of Russian troops.

The United States then abstained from voting on its own competing resolution after Europeans, led by France, succeeded in amending it to make clear Russia was the aggressor. The voting was taking place on the third anniversary of Russia’s invasion and as Trump was hosting French President Emmanuel Macron in Washington.

The growing divide followed Trump’s decision to open direct negotiations with

Russia on ending the war, dismaying Ukraine and its European supporters by excluding them from the preliminary talks last week.

The votes in the United Nations General Assembly were a major setback for the Trump administration in the world body, whose resolutions are not legally binding but are seen as a barometer of world opinion.

The United States then pushed for a vote on its original draft in the more powerful UN Security Council, where resolutions are legally binding and it has veto power along with Russia, China, Britain, and France. The vote in the 15-member council was 10-0 with five European countries abstaining – Britain, France, Denmark, Greece, and Slovenia.

In both the General Assembly and the Security Council, the United States and some of its closest allies, including Britain and France, were in opposing camps Mon-

day, a remarkable public fissure between countries that have typically stood together when it comes to Russia and Europe’s security.

The US “resolution puts us to the path to peace,” said Dorothy Camille Shea, the interim chargé d’affaires representing the United States, after the Security Council vote. “Now we must use it to build a peaceful future for Ukraine, Russia and the international community.”

But Britain’s ambassador, Barbara Woodward, in explaining its opposition to the measure, said: “The terms of the peace must send a message that aggression does not pay. This is why there can be no equivalence between Russia and Ukraine in how this council refers to the war.”

The dueling resolutions also reflect the tensions that have emerged between the United States and Ukraine. In escalating rhetoric, Trump has called Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky a “dictator” for not holding elections during wartime, when much of Ukraine is under Russian occupation and many of its soldiers are on

UKRAINE, Page A4

SOLEMN REMEMBRANCE



EVGENIY MALOLETKA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

People placed flowers at a memorial in Bucha for slain civilians during a ceremony on Monday to mark the third anniversary of the Russian invasion of Ukraine.

State to oversee Boston’s election department

Move in response to city’s lack of ballots at some polling sites

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

Secretary of State William F. Galvin said he’s appointing a receiver inside the city of Boston’s Elections Commission to help oversee the department through 2026, including for this year’s mayoral vote, after the department stumbled through several “unacceptable” problems last fall.

Galvin released an order Monday mandating several changes in the department after his office investigated and confirmed complaints that polling locations in the city didn’t receive enough ballots during November’s election.

State officials had been in talks with city officials, but Galvin said in a Globe interview that he determined last week they wouldn’t be able to reach a voluntary settlement that “was sufficient.”

Galvin said Monday his office’s probe found that the issues weren’t contained to a few precincts but were “citywide” and violated state law. His office said the city’s election officials also mishandled communications with poll workers, calling it a “systemic problem” amid an expectedly busy presidential election. Boston voters cast roughly 265,400 ballots in November, putting turnout at roughly 60 percent.

Among the problems Galvin’s office uncovered: Two phone lines the city set up to handle calls about machines breaking down and ballot-related problems received roughly 1,690 calls on Election Day, but the

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PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF/FILE 1997

ROBERTA FLACK DIES AT 88 —

The singer, known for her blend of soul, jazz, and folk, had three No. 1 hits in the 1970s. **C9.**

Supporters of the public/private White Stadium renovation plan went on the offensive Monday, saying the project, which would house a new women’s professional soccer team, will benefit Boston Public Schools’ resources. **B1.**

State Auditor Diana DiZoglio’s office says the MBTA Communities Act is an “unfunded mandate,” offering a new challenge to the state law that aims to spur more housing production in the suburbs. **D1.**

Clint Hill, the Secret Service agent who leaped onto President John F. Kennedy’s limousine as it came under fire in Dallas and prevented Jacqueline Kennedy from falling to the ground, has died at 93. **C10.**

The Vatican said Pope Francis showed slight improvement on Monday, but that his condition remained critical. **A5.**



Defrosted

Tuesday: Cloudy, mild. High 46-51, low 36-41.

Wednesday: Sunny, pleasant. High 49-54, low 35-40.

Obituaries, **C9.**

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

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